

Oakmonte Marketing Strategy

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Oakmonte is a content optimised e-market who's mvp is "to connect trusted sellers and trusted buyers and to reduce the distance AND HESITATION between wanting a product and getting it.

- strict merit system

- escrow approach

- smart sizing system

we're trying to push discovery/exploration based purchasing rather than intentional visits to the app (the platform should become a place where users truly come in for the sake of their need to visit the app, not to always be in specific search of something before coming in

- creator-driven content

- curators with everyday posts

- a focused HUB if you will

with this in mind...our final stage competitors will be tiktok shop, ig shop, facebook shop, depop, poshmark.....competitors...NOT ENEMY

Brand story and the enemy

Our story is individuality, originality, and creativity — Oakmonte exists for people who want to express their own style, not wear whatever fast fashion mass-produced this season.

The natural villain for that story is fast fashion itself: Temu, Shein, H&M — cheap, disposable, copy-paste style built on volume, not identity.

WHY- Oakmonte exists because we believe in individuality, in existing different, in **thinking different.**

we also believe that "your style is proof that you think different"

HOW-we created a platform for people to share and make momey off their styles and uniqueness

WHAT- we just happen to be an e-market

One thing worth being deliberate about: that villain framing will likely do more work outside Nigeria than inside it. Nigerian buyers

Locally, the sharper hook is trust, not villains: campaigns positioning Oakmonte as **the only safe space to buy fashion, cosmetics, and art** (escrow, vetted sellers, verified-purchase-only)

should carry the Nigerian go-to-market. The individuality/anti-fast-fashion story is the brand's long-term voice — worth building into content and tone now — but save the explicit villain campaign for when you're courting buyers outside Africa.

Where we are

- **Positioning**: a content optimised e-market, not just a store — the wedge is closing the gap between fashion content (inspiration, discovery) and actual successful purchase.
- **Differentiators we've committed to:**
 - escrow-backed trust
 - content optimised e-market
 - custom store fronts
 - smart size chart
 - creativity as a brand story
 - Oakmont wrapped (whatever you call it)
 - Buy for a friend
 - cop streaks
 - seller accountability
- **Built-in virality hooks from the product itself**: "Decision Room"/"Ask Friends" (in-app opinion requests before buying) and the "Decision Confidence" score are naturally shareable moments — worth treating as marketing surfaces, not just UX.
- **Beachhead**: Nigerian/African fashion first, to build cultural authority before the global "fashion as a concept" ambition (not sure).
- **Roles to market to separately:**
 - Buyers (curators) (teens/young adults + fashion enthusiasts+ creatives)

{content driven discovery(lot's of content), smart sizing, brand story, escrow, buy for a friend, ask a friend, genuinely good products, trend chasing(brand collabs or good brands)}

- Sellers (small brands/vendors/Tailors/Artists priced out of their own site or ad spend)

{Free customizable store fronts, built in audience (especially as getting a website get's increasingly easier), low effort imports, low effort set up, our ability to reduce returns, brand story}

[initially they mostly come in cause of cheapness, ease of use and functional advantages, later on...they come in cause that's where the audience is]

- Creators (creatives and fashion enthusiasts and models who post content, share their styles and potentially monetize).

{Monetization/collabs, their rep as creatives, potentially more traffic than on other platforms}

The rest of this doc turns that into channel, content, and launch suggestions to react to.

Curators

phase	Timeline	idea 1	Idea 2
Phase 1	Oct 5th - nov 1st	nothing showable yet (we prepare ads and content)	
Phase 2	Nov 1st - dec 30th	Free traffic from sellers pasting their store links in different bios, lot's of interesting content on the platform, win a few competitions	Content (personal, milestones and progress, apple level content, posters) all pushing ease of use and creativity, offline videos
Phase 3	Jan 1st - feb 30th	Brand collaborations, we create brands, more content, valentines day theme,	Blitz scaling, work with a macro or a number of micro influencers, buy for a friend,
Phase 4	march 1st- june 30th	Blitzscaling, announce public enemies	we work with a macro or a number of micro influencers, host fashion competitions
Phase 5	June 30th - 0	content, Blitz scaling, enemies made, a few lawsuits	Oakmonte wrapped, cop streaks, brand collab, influencers, host fashion competitions

Sellers

Phase	Time line	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels	
Phase 1	Oct 5th- nov 1st	cold text, cold call creators, artists, vendors, brands, tailors, creatives, editors to upload and set up stores on the platform 100 users of each groups should suffice	Personal outreach to hand-picked small brands, push every seller to put their Oakmonte storefront link in their existing bio, god father offer if you will	WhatsApp/IG DMs, personal network, Bumpa/Shopify/labeld seller communities	
Phase 2	nov 1st- dec 30th	Grow seller base and start surfacing real content and ads	Seller success stories, referral rewards, orders from the platform, great content, great ads	IG/TikTok/YT/Snap organic X for official launch and updates	
Phase 3	Jan 1st - June 30th	Scale seller acquisition publicly, valentine theme	Brand-collab exclusive drops, Blitz scale, get sabri suby and others to talk about us	Press, paid social, brand partnerships	
Phase 4	June 30th - sept 1st	Blitzscale, sellers come in because of the audience presently in oakmonte	Host fashion competitions, Oakmonte wrapped,	locations, the Oakmonte app	
Phase 5	sept 1st - dec 30th	Try to enter the live auction market	our specialty...deductive reasoning.		

Creators

Phase	Timeline	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 1	Oct 5th- nov 1st	Quietly recruit creators so there is content on day one	Personal invites to stylish/creative people, (pitch as "the platform that pays you for your taste")	Personal network, DMs

Phase	Timeline	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 2	nov 1st-dec 30th	Build out real content volume and formats, more creators	Trends for creators, collaborations for them, allow users gift creators, our creativity brand story, great ads and content	the oakmonte webapp.
Phase 3	Jan 1st - June 30th	Blitz scale creator recruitment publicly	campaigns, public enemies!, trends mostly	Public campaign, press
Phase 4	June 30th - sept 1st	Blitz scale	public enemies, fashion and art contests, creator incentives	omo

Channels and tactics

Prioritized for a bootstrapped, pre-launch stage — organic and relationship-driven first, paid later once there's a working funnel to point it at.

1. **Instagram and TikTok, organic first.** This is where Nigerian fashion discovery already happens and where Gen Z buying behavior is shifting toward in-feed, short-video-led shopping ([Shopify Nigeria: TikTok trends](#), [social commerce trends 2026](#)). Post the same "look → decision → purchase" moment the app is built around, not generic outfit content — make the Decision Room/Ask Friends mechanic itself the content hook ("help me decide" videos convert well and are genuinely shareable).
2. **Seller- and creator-led content, not brand-led.** Since sellers and creators are two of the three roles, their own posts are the cheapest and most credible acquisition channel for buyers. Give early sellers/creators simple content templates and a reason to post (visibility boosts, featured placement) instead of paying for ads.
3. **Referral and milestone rewards, not discounts** — this is already the house view, and it fits the trust positioning better than coupon-driven growth anyway.
4. **Campus presence for the buyer beachhead.** Teens/young adults + a Lagos-first launch points naturally at a small campus ambassador model at 1–2 universities before scaling — a handful of paid or equity-lite ambassadors doing IRL demos and posting, cheaper than broad-market influencer spend.

5. **WhatsApp and Instagram DMs for high-touch early trust-building** with the first cohort of sellers — fits the Nigerian commerce norm and lets you manually reinforce the vetting/escrow story while volume is low.
6. **PR/credibility moments.** The investor round and CAC registration are legitimate local press and founder-story hooks (Nigerian tech/startup press, LinkedIn, X) — useful for seller trust ("funded, real company") more than direct buyer acquisition.
7. **Paid ads later, not now.** Worth revisiting once there's a working activation funnel to measure CAC against — premature paid spend on an unproven funnel is the most common way early budget gets wasted.

Content, community, and partnership ideas

- **"Help me decide" series:** short videos of real buyers using Ask Friends before a purchase — turns a product feature into a content format, and it's genuine rather than staged social proof, consistent with the no-fake-engagement stance.
- **Verified-honesty angle:** lean into reviews only unlocking after a verified purchase as a selling point ("real reviews only" is a differentiator competitors built on seeded engagement can't credibly claim) — similar to how Poshmark's growth leaned on authentic seller community rather than paid acquisition ([Poshmark growth story](#), [Poshmark social commerce](#)).
- **Founder/building-in-public content:** posting build progress, seller onboarding milestones, and the investor/CAC story — cheap, builds trust with both sellers and buyers before the product is polished.
- **Creator monetization as a recruiting pitch:** position Oakmonte to fashion-interested creators as "the platform that pays you for your taste," not just another place to post — recruit a small founding cohort of creators before public launch so there's content on day one.
- **Campus ambassador / style-lead program:** 1-2 universities, a handful of ambassadors who host small styling meetups or drops and post about them — similar in spirit to how brands run campus ambassador programs in Nigeria today ([campus ambassador programs 2026](#)).
- **Seller success stories:** small vendors who couldn't afford their own site getting real sales — this is the sellers'-side proof point and doubles as recruiting content for more seller
- The brand story of creativity
- our villains

- just good content fr

Segment Playbooks & Budget

Sellers first, creators next, curators last, matching the launch sequencing on the main tab. Timelines below are a proposal to align on with your co-founder, especially the creator column, which is still an open call.

Sellers

Phase	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 1 -- Cold start (Now to ~Month 2)	Seed the first real catalogue and free storefronts	Personal outreach to hand-picked small brands; Shopify/Bumpa/CSV catalogue import; push every seller to put their Oakmonte storefront link in their existing bio	WhatsApp/IG DMs, personal network, Bumpa/Shopify seller communities
Phase 2 -- Soft launch (~Month 2 to 4)	Grow seller base and start surfacing real content	Seller success stories; referral rewards for seller-refers-seller; small seller meetups	IG/TikTok organic, WhatsApp groups
Phase 3 -- Main launch and growth (Month 4+)	Scale seller acquisition publicly	Brand-collab exclusive drops; PR off the investor/CAC story; paid seller acquisition once the funnel is proven	Press, paid social, brand partnerships

Creators

Timeline below assumes a light, quiet creator track starting alongside sellers rather than waiting for main launch -- confirm this with your co-founder before treating it as settled.

Phase	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 1 -- Cold start (Now to ~Month 2)	Quietly recruit a small founding creator cohort so there is content on day one	Personal invites to stylish/creative people; pitch as "the platform that pays you for your taste"	Personal network, DMs
Phase 2 -- Soft launch (~Month 2 to 4)	Build out real content volume and formats	"Help me decide"/Ask Friends content series; creator monetization messaging; campus style-lead program	IG/TikTok organic, campus ambassadors
Phase 3 -- Main launch and growth (Month 4+)	Scale creator recruitment publicly	Open creator applications; brand-collab tie-ins; fashion/art show recruiting	Public campaign, events, press

Curators

Phase	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 1 -- Cold start (Now to ~Month 2)	None by design	No curator marketing; only incidental traffic from sellers' bio links	--
Phase 2 -- Soft launch (~Month 2 to 4)	Minimal	Optional small waitlist teaser at most; platform stays effectively private	--

Phase	Objective	Key tactics	Primary channels
Phase 3 -- Main launch and growth (Month 4+)	Public buyer acquisition	"Only safe space to buy fashion, cosmetics, and art" trust campaign; fast-fashion-villain messaging (test with diaspora/international audiences first); referral and milestone rewards; PR from the investor story; brand-collab drops as awareness hooks	IG/TikTok organic and paid, PR, brand collabs, campus ambassadors doubling as curator recruiters

Marketing cost worksheet

A starting point to react to, not a committed budget. Nano/micro creator rates are pulled from a 2026 Nigeria influencer cost guide (quoted in USD, converted here at roughly NGN 1,395 to \$1 as of Sep 20, 2026 -- see Sources on the main tab). Campus ambassador stipends and event costs have no solid public benchmark, so those rows are placeholders to replace with real quotes once you're pricing them. Cold-start-phase seller and creator recruitment is assumed to be personal outreach at close to zero cash cost, so this worksheet mostly prices Phase 2 to 3 activity.

Line item	Assumption	Unit cost (NGN)	Example qty	Subtotal (NGN)
Nano creator seeding	1 post each, one-off	70,000 to 420,000	5	350,000 to 2,100,000
Micro creator partnership	1 post each, one-off	280,000 to 1,400,000	2	560,000 to 2,800,000
Campus ambassador stipend	Monthly, placeholder -- confirm locally	20,000 to 50,000	2	40,000 to 100,000
Content production (shoots)	Per shoot, monthly	50,000 to 150,000	2/month	100,000 to 300,000
Referral/milestone reward pool	Monthly pool, placeholder	--	--	100,000 to 300,000

Line item	Assumption	Unit cost (NGN)	Example qty	Subtotal (NGN)
Illustrative monthly total				1,150,000 to 5,600,000

Rough formula to reuse as the plan firms up: monthly creator-seeding budget is about (nano creators x unit cost) + (micro creators x unit cost) + ambassador stipends + content production + the referral/reward pool. Swap in real counts and real quotes as they come in -- the ranges above are wide on purpose.

New idea: make the bio-link loop measurable

Since the seller storefront link (already built) is the main pre-launch acquisition channel, it's worth giving each seller's link a distinct, trackable identifier (their store username already provides this) and logging clicks/signups per seller from day one, even a simple count is enough to start. Two things that unlocks: knowing which sellers are actually driving buyer traffic, so referral rewards can target the sellers who deserve them instead of anyone who asks; and a real, measured number to plug into the CAC side of the cost worksheet above instead of leaving "organic" as a guess.

Smaller, separate idea: before spending on the fast-fashion-villain messaging internationally, it's cheap to informally test 2 to 3 versions of the trust-focused tagline (for example "the only safe space to shop fashion, cosmetics, and art" vs. a shorter "shop safe, shop Oakmonte" vs. a benefit-led "never get scammed buying fashion online again") with a small group before picking one to build campaigns around.